

One team for the whole interior.

EDM Holdings is a specialist interior fit-out and drywall contractor, delivering in the UAE. Every trade inside the interior, self-delivered by directly employed people, under one contract.

What's in here.

A word from the Chief Executive	Why the business is built the way it is.
The model	Self-delivery, and the commercial reason for it.
The trades	What we install, and to what standard.
The craft	The details that decide whether a package is easy or expensive.
Sectors	Workplace, residential, hotels and leisure, education — and what each demands.
Mission-critical delivery	What data centre work teaches a fit-out contractor.
Evidence	Four systems built in-house, and the handover standard they produce.
Safety	The controls, and why we describe them rather than score them.
Our people	Why the workforce is directly employed, and who leads it.
Working with us	What a main contractor can expect, from first enquiry to final account.
Careers	Who we're looking for.

**The work is still done by people standing on a floor with a level.
Everything else is arrangement.**

We build the inside of buildings, and we do it with our own people.

That sentence is the whole business, and almost every decision we have taken follows from it.

Most interior packages get split across four or five trade subcontractors. Everyone in construction knows what happens next. The gaps between those contracts are where programme slips, where quality arguments start, and where a main contractor ends up refereeing a dispute they had no part in causing.

We decided to take those gaps into our own scope instead. One contract, one team on site, one standard from setting out to final snag. It is not a clever idea. It is simply harder to run, which is why it stays rare.

Directly employing our workforce costs more on paper than buying labour when we need it. It also means we know our real outputs, our people turn up because they work for us, and

the promises we make are ours to keep rather than someone else's to break.

The other decision worth explaining is the record. Fire-stopping, head-of-wall detail and everything else inside a wall disappears the day it is boarded. We photograph and sign it before it goes, and hand the whole record over as a pack. Clients rarely ask for that at tender stage. They are extremely glad of it eighteen months later when a consultant wants evidence.

Our people have worked in this trade since 1986. Most of what we know was learned the hard way on sites in the UK and Ireland, and it now runs to the same standard here in the UAE.

If you are pricing an interior package, send us the drawings and the programme. You will get a straight answer, the same working day.

Damien Meenan

Chief Executive, EDM Holdings

Every split in a package is an interface. Every interface is a risk somebody carries.

A typical interior package is let to four or five specialists. Each is competent. Each holds a different programme, a different quality plan and a different view of where their scope ends.

The gaps between them are where projects lose time. A ceiling grid set out before the partition line is confirmed. A glazed screen ordered to a dimension that moved. Fire-stopping that belongs to whoever was there last. None of it shows on a tender comparison, and all of it lands on the main contractor's desk as a coordination problem nobody priced.

One programme	Sequencing between trades is an internal scheduling matter for us rather than a negotiation between subcontractors with different incentives.
One quality plan	The same inspection stages and tolerances from setting out to final decoration. The standard doesn't change hands halfway through the floor.
One point of responsibility	There is no interface argument to referee, because there is nobody to argue with. If something in the interior is wrong, it is ours.
One set of records	Produced by one system as the work happens, rather than assembled from four suppliers at the end.
One commercial conversation	A single valuation, a single variation account and a single final account for the whole interior.

Self-delivery costs more than the cheapest combination of subcontract prices. It costs less by handover, and the difference never appears on the tender comparison.

What we install.



Drywall partitions & ceilings

Metal-stud partitions, shaft walls, MF and suspended ceilings, dry lining and encasements. Set out from a survey of what was actually built, and built square the first time.



Fire & acoustic-rated systems

Built to the certified detail — the tested arrangement, not the convenient one — and documented as we go, so they stand up to inspection at handover and to diligence afterwards.



Timber wall & ceiling panels

Veneered and slatted finishes, acoustic-backed where required. Specified for how they look, and capable of real acoustic work when the build-up behind them is right.



Aluminium & glazing

Single and double-glazed partition systems, framed or frameless, to open up the floorplate. Performance decided at the head, the floor detail and the void above, not by the glass alone.



Painting & decoration

Commercial-grade paint and decorative finishes to a defined, handover-ready level — agreed against a benchmark panel up front, not argued at the end.



Joinery

Reception counters, tea points, storage and feature joinery, made to drawing and fitted by the same team that built the walls around it — which is why the junctions work.

Every trade above is delivered under EDM supervision to one programme, one quality plan and one point of responsibility.

Drywall looks simple from a distance.

Most of the cost risk in an interior package sits in a small number of details, and every one of them is decided before anybody starts boarding.

Setting out

From a survey of the as-built structure, not the architectural drawing alone. Slabs get poured out of tolerance and existing buildings are never what the record says. Half a day proving the grid prevents a floor of walls sitting three millimetres out against joinery made to drawing.

Head-of-wall

Partitions are rigid; slabs deflect. If the head detail doesn't allow for the movement the structural design predicts, the board cracks along the top or the studs take load they were never designed for. Right gap, right fixing centres, fire-stopped to the tested arrangement.

Fire-stopping

The least visible work in the package and the most consequential. The right product, in the right gap, at every point a service crosses a compartment line — photographed and signed before it is covered, because the only way to check it afterwards is to cut into the wall.

Risers and shaft walls

Where drywall and services have their argument. Most risers can only be built from one side, which changes the system, the sequence and the access. On paper there is always room, because on paper nothing has a bracket or a tolerance.

Acoustic continuity

A partition performs at its junctions, not in the middle of the panel. A well-built acoustic wall with an open ceiling void above the line performs about as well as a doorway.

None of this is unusual knowledge. It is what a firm learns by being wrong on a live job, and it is priced into what an experienced contractor quotes.

The trades are the same everywhere. The demands are not.

Workplace

Cat A and Cat B. Grade-A floors where the finish is the product. The expensive part is the seam: Cat A ceilings and services designed with no knowledge of the Cat B layout, so the tenant's partitions land under a diffuser and half the grid comes back out. We deliver both scopes, which means we can say at Cat A stage which decisions get expensive later.

Residential

Repetition at volume. Output rates, consistent detailing and unit-by-unit sign-off matter more than any single feature. A detail that is thirty seconds slower is a fortnight across a tower.

Hotels & leisure

Acoustic separation between keys is the whole job, and it is decided at the junctions. Heavy feature finishes, and a handover date usually tied to a trading opening that will not move.

Education

Fixed holiday windows with no tolerance either side, hard-wearing detailing built for use rather than for a photograph, and compliance documentation that actually gets read.

ENVIRONMENTS

New build, refurbishment, occupied buildings and live operational facilities — including permit-controlled areas with restricted access and out-of-hours working. Strip-out is delivered as part of the package, because the team clearing the floor is the team that has to build on it.

What a data centre teaches a fit-out contractor.

Our current UAE delivery is a thirteen-zone interior package inside a 100MW data centre, as subcontractor to a Tier-1 main contractor.

The trades are the same as any fit-out: partitions, boards, fire-stopping, finishes. What changes is the tolerance, the inspection regime and the consequence of getting it wrong. Everything is documented, everything is witnessed, and nothing is closed in on a promise.

The works are structured across thirteen zones, each built, inspected and handed over in sequence, so the wider programme keeps moving while we deliver. The following trades get a finished area rather than an assurance.

Tolerance	Tighter than commercial fit-out, and checked rather than assumed.
Inspection	Witnessed and recorded at each stage. A zone does not close on anyone's word.
Coordination	Daily, with every trade working around us in a live and permit-controlled environment.
Handover	Zone by zone, with the record complete on the day rather than assembled at the end.

A firm that can hold that discipline on a mission-critical site can hold it comfortably on a Grade-A office floor. It rarely transfers the other way.

Client and project references are available on request, subject to client consent.

Four systems, built in-house, that follow one wall from tender to handover.

Most subcontractors price on one system, build on another and report on a third, and none of them talk to each other. We built our own instead, because the thread between them is where the commercial value sits.

01 • PRICE IT

EDM Measure

Drawing-based takeoff. Every wall run traced and landed in a live, priced bill against a wall reference, built from real wall build-ups rather than a rate per square metre.

Load a new revision over the old and what changed is highlighted — so a variation is measured before anyone argues about whether there is one.

02 • PROVE IT

EDM Evidence

Eight inspection stages per wall, signed and dated by the supervisor who looked at it. The two stages that matter — services closed in, and fire-stopping — will not accept a pass without a photograph.

Failed checks stay on the record beside the passes. That is what makes a pass worth something.

03 • REPORT IT

EDM Progress

Planned stage dates by zone form the programme; actual progress fills in from what supervisors have already signed. Percentage complete comes from records, not a walk-round.

Hold-ups are logged the day they happen and closed when they clear. That dated log is the extension-of-time conversation.

04 • RECORD IT

EDM Daybook

One page a day on the site manager's phone. Labour, weather, deliveries, snags — and every instruction received, with who gave it, when, and a photograph if there is something to see.

Ten seconds on the day turns a verbal instruction into a priced variation instead of a disagreement in March.

Evidence, not promises.

The riskiest moment in any drywall package is the day a wall is boarded over. Once it is closed, nobody can see what is behind it — and years later, somebody has to prove what was built. We decided that proof should be part of the product.

1 Every wall has a number

Assigned at tender stage and kept through construction into the handover file. The wall we priced, built and are claiming for is provably the same wall.

2 Every stage is inspected and signed

Setting out, framing, services closed in, insulation, each layer of board, fire-stopping, decoration — dated and initialled by the supervisor who looked at it.

3 Photographed before it disappears

No wall is boarded without a photograph of the services inside it. No fire-stopping is signed off without a picture of the seal.

4 Handed over as a pack, not a promise

Every wall, every check, every photograph, as one document your team can file, audit and rely on — per zone where the works are zoned.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Nothing. It is how we work. The systems are ours, built in-house, and they travel with every EDM package as standard. What we ask in return is that the inspection and test plan and the benchmark standard are agreed early, so the record measures the right things against a standard both parties have signed.

We describe our controls rather than score them.

A lot of construction safety communication is a number and a slogan. Neither tells a main contractor's HSE team anything they can check, so we set out the system instead.

Before work starts

Method statements, risk assessments and material approvals submitted and signed off in advance. Nothing starts on a verbal.

Every day

Operatives inducted, directly supervised and briefed at daily toolbox talks — specific to the floor and the day. What has changed since yesterday, who is working above, where the new penetration is, what the permit covers and what it doesn't.

In live environments

Permit discipline, restricted access and out-of-hours working handled as normal conditions rather than exceptions.

On the record

Full HSE documentation, insurances and supporting records set out in our PQQ information pack, available on request.

A toolbox talk that opens with "safety is everyone's responsibility" has already lost the room. The ones that work are specific, short, and treated as real by somebody senior.

Housekeeping belongs in this section too. Material stacked rather than dumped, offcuts cleared, edge protection in place. It is the most reliable indicator of how a site is being run, and it is visible within ten minutes of walking a floor.

The workforce is not a cost line. It is the product.

In a self-delivery business, everything a client is buying arrives on site in a van. Which is why our labour is directly employed rather than brokered through a chain of suppliers with our logo on the hoarding.

Known outputs. We have measured the same crews over years, so the programme we sign up to is one we have genuinely resourced rather than one we hope to achieve.

A standard that holds. Quality is not the standard of the best wall on the job. It is the standard of the four hundredth, built on a Thursday afternoon by a crew who are behind. That is set by supervision, not by intent.

Answers from someone who was there. A question about a detail on Level 4 goes to the supervisor who signed it off, not down a chain to a supplier who demobilised a fortnight ago.

Teams that self-correct. Crews who have worked together for years notice the setting out is off before the third wall goes up, and flag a detail that won't work before it is built four hundred times. That is worth more than any individual's skill.

Supervision is European led and European managed, and the workforce scales with the package rather than being assembled for it.

Four people, and what each of them owns.

A specialist subcontractor is a small number of people making the same decisions consistently. These are ours.



CHAIRMAN

Eddie Duffy

Co-founder and Chairman, setting strategic direction across the group. Eddie's focus is growth that holds, long-term client relationships and the quality of what actually gets built in the UAE. Four decades in specialist interiors, and the view that a contractor should own the whole interior rather than a slice of it.



CHIEF EXECUTIVE
OFFICER

Damien Meenan

Co-founder and Chief Executive, running the business day to day, with a remit spanning the group's interests in Dubai, Ireland, Australia and London. Twenty-five years in the trade, and the holder of the two commitments the model depends on: directly employed labour, and a record of the work made as it is built.



CHIEF OPERATING
OFFICER

**Christopher
Simon**

Chief Operating Officer, responsible for EDM's operations in the Middle East and the named contact for tender and pre-qualification enquiries. Over twenty-two years in senior commercial property and operations roles in London and Dubai, which is why he reads a package as a date, a number and a risk before it is a wall.



PROJECT DIRECTOR

**Kenny
Buchanan**

Twenty years in interior fit-out, drywall and every trade EDM self-delivers, on projects in Ireland, London, the UAE and Australia. That time on site shapes how the team plans a package and holds it to programme.

What a main contractor can expect.

1 The enquiry

Send the drawings and the programme. You get an acknowledgement and a first read the same working day, including a view on whether anything in the pack is going to cause a problem later.

2 The price

Built from wall build-ups rather than a rate per square metre, with a labour build-up we can produce in ten minutes, the assumptions we priced on, and the qualifications that matter. Nothing buried in a covering letter.

3 Mobilisation

RAMS and approvals signed off before work starts. Setting out proved against a survey. The wall reference plan posted in the site cabin so anyone can see what is built, what is inspected and what is waiting. Benchmark panel agreed in week two.

4 Delivery

Daily briefings, weekly reporting on a fixed day, and snags closed as we go while the trades are still on the floor and the access is still up.

5 Commercially

Changes raised when they occur, not at final account. Instructions logged on the day. Valuations supported by the same records that support the programme.

6 Handover

The full record, per zone, complete on the day.

IF A DATE IS AT RISK

You hear it from us while there is still something anyone can do about it. We would rather flag something awkward early and occasionally be wrong than be diplomatic and be right too late.

Our PQQ pack is assembled, not assembled on request.

Most of a pre-qualification exercise is chasing. Tell us the format your supply chain system needs and we will provide it in that format rather than sending a folder and hoping.

Held and ready

Trade licence and company registration, insurances, health and safety policy, RAMS templates, quality plan, the published handover standard, and references relevant to the sector you are asking about.

Commercial information

Turnover, audited accounts and insurance limits are provided in the pack rather than published, so you receive figures alongside the documents that support them.

References

Package-specific, on request. Where a client requires consent before being named, we ask them first — including for our current UAE delivery.

Contracting entity

In the UAE we contract through EDM Technical Services L.L.C, our Dubai-licensed delivery entity, wholly owned by EDM Consultant FZCO.

WHERE WE WORK

UAE

DELIVERY

Ireland

TRACK RECORD

United Kingdom

TRACK RECORD

Australia

GROUP INTEREST

We contract and deliver in the UAE. The delivered track record behind this team was built in the UK and Ireland, and it is the reason our supervision, our inspection regime and our handover standard look the way they do.

We are always interested in good tradespeople.

A self-delivery contractor is only as good as the people it employs, so recruitment is not something we do when a project lands. It is continuous.

Who we look for

Fixers, tapers, ceiling hands, glazing installers and working supervisors. People who take pride in a snag-free finish and who turn up.

What we offer

Steady work with one employer rather than a chain of agencies. Proper supervision. Sites where the paperwork exists to protect the people doing the job rather than to chase them.

Supervisors

We hire for the thing that cannot be taught: whether the standard holds when nobody is watching. Everything else we can train.

How to apply

Send what you cover and where you are available to enquiries@edmholdings.ae.

Hire for whether a supervisor renegotiates the standard at four o'clock on a Thursday. Everything else can be taught.

Send us the drawings and the programme.

Whether you are pricing a package, planning a programme or adding us to your supply chain, a short conversation is usually quicker than a document.

Christopher Simon · Chief Operating Officer

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What helps most

Drawings, the programme, and the date you need a price by. If there is a fire strategy and a partition schedule, send those too — the price comes back firmer and the qualifications shorter.

Response

A real person, the same working day.

Also available

Capability statement, handover standard and PQQ information pack, on request or from edmholdings.ae.

The interior shell, built right the first time.
